John 4 - 6

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Prophecy Fulfilled (WEB)

A tired man sitting on the edge of a well at noon.

That is how chapter 4 opens. The Word who was there before the beginning, worn out from walking, asking a stranger for a drink.

And the stranger is the wrong person three times over. A Samaritan. A woman. And a woman who comes for water at the hour nobody else does.

He offers her living water, and she thinks He means the plumbing.

Then He tells her everything she ever did - and instead of running from it, she runs into town shouting about it.

She leaves her water jar behind. She came for water and went home with a well.

Then a royal official walks twenty miles to beg for his son, and is sent home with nothing but a sentence. And he believes the sentence before he sees anything.

Then a pool full of sick people, and one man who has been lying there for thirty-eight years.

Thirty-eight years. The same number of years Israel wandered after Kadesh until a whole generation was gone.

Do you want to be made well? And he never actually says yes. He explains why it is not his fault.

Rise, take up your mat, and walk. And the first thing anybody says to the healed man is that he is carrying it on the wrong day.

Then the longest speech in the book so far - the Son who does what He sees the Father doing, the dead who will hear His voice, and four witnesses called to the stand.

You search the Scriptures. They testify about Me. And you will not come to Me.

Then five barley loaves and two small fish, and five thousand men sitting down on green grass at Passover time.

Twelve baskets of leftovers, because nothing is to be wasted.

And a crowd that wants to make Him king by force - so He walks away up a mountain alone.

Then a storm at night, and a figure walking on the water, and two words in Greek: ego eimi. It is I. I AM.

And the next day the hardest sermon He ever preaches. I am the bread of life. Eat My flesh. Drink My blood.

And the crowd thins out until it is just twelve men standing there.

Will you also go away?

Lord, to whom would we go? You have the words of eternal life.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 4 - A Tired Man at a Well, Living Water, and a Word That Healed From Twenty Miles

Key Notes

- Yahshua Himself did not baptize; His disciples did. John stops to correct the rumor in the middle of a sentence (John 4:1-2).
- “He needed to pass through Samaria” uses the same small verb John uses for the Son of Man who must be lifted up and the friend who must decrease. The road through Samaria was the shortest way north, but in this Gospel that word usually means more than geography (John 4:4, 3:14, 3:30).
- Sychar sits near the ground Jacob gave to Joseph, and Joseph’s bones were buried at Shechem in that same field. This conversation happens on family land (John 4:5, Genesis 48:22, Joshua 24:32).
- He was tired. The Word who made all things got worn out walking and sat down on the edge of a well. John does not let the reader forget the flesh (John 4:6).
- “About the sixth hour” counts from sunrise, so about noon - the heat of the day, when water was not usually drawn. Some readers take it as Roman reckoning from midnight, which would make it six in the evening. Either way John wants the hour remembered (John 4:6, 19:14).
- A man and a woman meeting at a well is one of the oldest scenes in Scripture. Abraham’s servant found Rebekah at a well, Jacob met Rachel at one, Moses met Zipporah at one. Every time it leads to a marriage. And John has just finished calling Yahshua the bridegroom (John 4:7, 3:29, Genesis 24:11-14, 29:9-11).
- “Jews have no dealings with Samaritans” may be narrower in the Greek - they do not share vessels. Which is exactly what He has just asked to do. He wants a drink from her jar (John 4:9).
- The Samaritans traced back to the peoples the king of Assyria settled in the land after the northern kingdom fell, who feared Yahweh and served their own gods at the same time. Seven hundred years later the wound was still open (John 4:9, 2 Kings 17:24, 33).
- “Living water” in ordinary speech meant running water, from a spring, as opposed to water standing in a cistern. She hears plumbing. He means what Jeremiah meant when Yahweh called Himself the spring of living waters (John 4:10-11, Jeremiah 2:13).
- “Are you greater than our father Jacob?” is the first of two such questions in John. Four chapters later someone asks if He is greater than Abraham. Both times the honest answer is yes (John 4:12, 8:53).
- “A spring of water welling up” uses a verb for leaping or springing up. The water He gives does not sit still in a person (John 4:14).
- He does not shame her and He does not skip it. Go, call your husband. She answers with a half-truth, and He tells her it is true and fills in the other half. That is the whole conversation about her past (John 4:16-18).

- Some readers see the five husbands as a picture of Samaria's history, since the king of Assyria brought in peoples from five cities. It is a possible echo. The text gives no sign that she is anything but a real woman with a real history (John 4:18, 2 Kings 17:24).
- "This mountain" is Gerizim, where Moses had the blessing proclaimed, and where the Samaritans built their own temple. It had been destroyed by a Jewish king more than a century before this conversation, and they still worshipped on the ruins (John 4:20, Deuteronomy 11:29).
- He takes a side - salvation is from the Jews - and in the same breath says the side is about to stop mattering. The hour is coming when neither mountain will be the place (John 4:21-22).
- "In spirit and truth" is not inward instead of real. It is worship that answers to who God actually is. And the line most people skip: the Father is seeking such people. Worship is something He is looking for (John 4:23-24).
- The Samaritans accepted only the five books of Moses, so the Messiah they waited for was the prophet like Moses promised in Deuteronomy 18. She expects someone who will tell them everything (John 4:25, Deuteronomy 18:18).
- "I am he" is two words in Greek: ego eimi, I am. It is the first time in the Gospel He says it, and He says it to a Samaritan woman at noon (John 4:26).
- She left her water jar. She had come to draw water, and she forgot it, which tells you what kind of conversation it was (John 4:28).
- "Come, see a man who told me everything that I did" is the same invitation Philip gave Nathanael. Come and see. She becomes the first person in John to bring a whole town (John 4:29, 1:46).
- "My food is to do the will of him who sent me." The disciples went to buy lunch. He had already eaten (John 4:32-34).
- Four months from sowing to harvest was a farmer's saying. He tells them to look up, and what they would have seen coming down the road from Sychar was a crowd of Samaritans (John 4:35, 4:30).
- "Savior of the world" is said in the New Testament only here and in John's first letter. The first people in this Gospel to say it are Samaritans (John 4:42, 1 John 4:14).
- A prophet has no honor in his own country. The other Gospels use the saying of Nazareth. John places it here, as He heads back into Galilee (John 4:44).
- The nobleman is a royal official, likely in the service of Herod Antipas. Cana to Capernaum is about twenty miles, uphill all the way from the lake. He walked it to ask (John 4:46-47).
- "Unless you see signs and wonders" is plural - you all. It is spoken to the crowd as much as to the father (John 4:48).
- "The man believed the word that Jesus spoke to him, and he went his way." He believed before anything happened. The servants met him on the road the next day with the news (John 4:50-51).

- The fever left at the seventh hour, the very hour the word was spoken, from twenty miles away. Distance did not slow the word down (John 4:52-53, Psalm 107:20).
- John numbers the first two signs, both at Cana, and then stops counting. From here the reader is trusted to keep track (John 4:54, 2:11).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Jacob's Field and Joseph's Bones	John 4:5 • Genesis 48:22 • Joshua 24:32
Meetings at a Well	John 4:7 • Genesis 24:11-14 • Genesis 29:9-11
Where the Samaritans Came From	John 4:9 • 2 Kings 17:24 • 2 Kings 17:33
The Spring of Living Waters	John 4:10 • Jeremiah 2:13 • Jeremiah 17:13
This Mountain	John 4:20 • Deuteronomy 11:29 • Deuteronomy 12:5
Salvation Is From the Jews	John 4:22 • Isaiah 2:3 • Romans 9:4-5
Fields White for Harvest	John 4:35 • Amos 9:13 • Matthew 9:37-38
A Prophet in His Own Country	John 4:44 • Matthew 13:57 • Luke 4:24

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
Water From the Wells of Salvation	John 4:14 • Isaiah 12:3 • Isaiah 44:3
Worship in Every Place	John 4:23 • Malachi 1:11 • Zephaniah 3:9
The Prophet Like Moses	John 4:25 • Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18
I Am He Who Speaks	John 4:26 • Isaiah 52:6 • Isaiah 43:10
The Savior of the World	John 4:42 • Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 45:22
He Sent His Word and Healed	John 4:50 • Psalm 107:20 • Isaiah 55:11

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 4 Commentary (David Guzik) - the woman at the well, worship in spirit and truth, and the nobleman's son
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 4A - exposition of the Samaritan woman and the harvest

John 4 - Opening Intro

This chapter opens with the Son of God too tired to keep walking.

It is about noon. The disciples have gone into town for food. And He sits down on the edge of Jacob's well, on land Jacob gave to Joseph, and He waits.

And a woman comes out to draw water.

Now, nobody draws water at noon. You go in the cool of the morning or the evening, with everybody else, and you talk while you fill your jar. A woman who comes alone in the heat of the day is a woman who does not want to be talked about.

And He says: give me a drink.

Three walls come down in that one sentence. He is a Jew and she is a Samaritan. He is a man and she is a woman. And He is a rabbi asking to drink from her jar, which no rabbi would touch.

She says exactly that. How is it that you, a Jew, ask a drink of me?

And He says: if you knew who was asking, you would have asked Him, and He would have given you living water.

Now living water, in normal talk, means running water. Spring water, as opposed to the flat water sitting at the bottom of a cistern. So she looks at Him like He is not making sense. You have nothing to draw with, and this well is deep. Where is this water coming from?

And then the question with an edge on it: are you greater than our father Jacob?

And He does not answer it. He just tells her the difference between the two waters. Whoever drinks this will be thirsty again. Whoever drinks what I give will never thirst - it will be a spring welling up inside him.

And she says: give me that, so I never have to come back here.

Hear that. So I never have to come back here. She is still thinking about not having to walk out to this well at noon in front of nobody.

And He says: go call your husband.

I have no husband.

And He says - and listen to how gently He does this - you are right. You have had five, and the one you have now is not your husband. What you said is true.

He does not shame her. And He does not skip it. He names the thing she came out at noon to avoid, and He tells her she told the truth.

And she does what all of us do when it gets too close. She changes the subject to religion. Our fathers worshipped on this mountain, and you people say Jerusalem.

And He actually answers her. He does not wave it away. Salvation is from the Jews - He takes a side. And then He says the side is about to stop mattering. The hour is coming, and now is, when the true worshippers will worship the Father in spirit and truth.

And then the line that I think is the center of the chapter. The Father is seeking such people to worship Him.

He is looking for them. He came out to a well at noon to find one.

She says: I know Messiah is coming. When He comes, He will tell us everything.

And He says: I am He. The one speaking to you.

In Greek that is two words. Ego eimi. I am. It is the first time He says it in this book, and He says it to a Samaritan woman with five husbands behind her, at noon, by a well.

Then the disciples come back with lunch and they are stunned that He is talking to a woman. And not one of them asks why.

And she leaves her water jar.

She runs back into the town she has been avoiding and says: come, see a man who told me everything I ever did.

That is the person who did not want to be seen, telling the whole town what she did.

Meanwhile the disciples are trying to get Him to eat, and He says: I have food you do not know about. My food is to do the will of Him who sent Me.

And He says, you have a saying - four more months and then the harvest. Look up. The fields are already white.

And if they looked up, what were they looking at? The Samaritans coming down the road from Sychar.

And those Samaritans end up saying the biggest thing anybody says in the chapter. We have heard for ourselves, and we know this is the Savior of the world.

Then back in Galilee, a royal official walks twenty miles from Capernaum to Cana because his son is dying. Come down before my child dies.

And He says: go your way. Your son lives.

That is it. No trip. No touch. Just a sentence.

And the man believed the word and went home. And on the road his servants meet him. The fever broke yesterday, at the seventh hour - the same hour the word was spoken.

Before we read - notice how many times in this chapter somebody is given nothing but a word, and the word turns out to be enough.

John 4:1-54 (WEB)

1 Therefore when the Lord knew that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus was making and baptizing more disciples than John

2 (although Jesus himself didn't baptize, but his disciples),

3 he left Judea, and departed into Galilee.

4 He needed to pass through Samaria.

5 So he came to a city of Samaria, called Sychar, near the parcel of ground that Jacob gave to his son, Joseph.[1]

6 Jacob's well was there. Jesus therefore, being tired from his journey, sat down by the well. It was about the sixth hour.

7 A woman of Samaria came to draw water. Jesus said to her, "Give me a drink."[2]

8 For his disciples had gone away into the city to buy food.

9 The Samaritan woman therefore said to him, "How is it that you, being a Jew, ask for a drink from me, a Samaritan woman?" (For Jews have no dealings with Samaritans.)[3]

10 Jesus answered her, "If you knew the gift of God, and who it is who says to you, 'Give me a drink,' you would have asked him, and he would have given you living water."[4]

11 The woman said to him, "Sir, you have nothing to draw with, and the well is deep. So where do you get that living water?

12 Are you greater than our father, Jacob, who gave us the well, and drank of it himself, as did his children, and his livestock?"

13 Jesus answered her, "Everyone who drinks of this water will thirst again,

14 but whoever drinks of the water that I will give him will never thirst again; but the water that I will give him will become in him a well of water springing up to eternal life."[5]

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[1] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 48:22 • Joshua 24:32 - *Jacob giving Joseph one portion above his brothers, and Joseph's bones buried at Shechem in the field Jacob bought*

[2] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 24:11-14 • Genesis 29:9-11 - *Abraham's servant at the well asking a woman for a drink, and Jacob meeting Rachel at the well and watering her flock*

[3] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Kings 17:24 • 2 Kings 17:33 - *the king of Assyria settling foreign peoples in Samaria, who feared Yahweh and served their own gods*

[4] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 2:13 • Jeremiah 17:13 - *Yahweh the spring of living waters, forsaken for broken cisterns that hold no water*

15 The woman said to him, “Sir, give me this water, so that I don’t get thirsty, neither come all the way here to draw.”

16 Jesus said to her, “Go, call your husband, and come here.”

17 The woman answered, “I have no husband.” Jesus said to her, “You said well, ‘I have no husband,’

18 for you have had five husbands; and he whom you now have is not your husband. This you have said truly.”

19 The woman said to him, “Sir, I perceive that you are a prophet.

20 Our fathers worshiped in this mountain, and you Jews say that in Jerusalem is the place where people ought to worship.”[6]

21 Jesus said to her, “Woman, believe me, the hour comes, when neither in this mountain, nor in Jerusalem, will you worship the Father.

22 You worship that which you don’t know. We worship that which we know; for salvation is from the Jews.[7]

23 But the hour comes, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for the Father seeks such to be his worshipers.[8]

24 God is spirit, and those who worship him must worship in spirit and truth.”

25 The woman said to him, “I know that Messiah comes, he who is called Christ. When he has come, he will declare to us all things.”[9]

26 Jesus said to her, “I am he, the one who speaks to you.”[10]

27 At this, his disciples came. They marveled that he was speaking with a woman; yet no one said, “What are you looking for?” or, “Why do you speak with her?”

28 So the woman left her water pot, and went away into the city, and said to the people,

29 “Come, see a man who told me everything that I did. Can this be the Christ?”

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[5] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 12:3 • Isaiah 44:3 - *drawing water with joy from the wells of salvation, and water poured on the thirsty with the Spirit on their descendants*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 11:29 • Deuteronomy 12:5 - *the blessing set on Mount Gerizim, and the place Yahweh would choose to put his name*

[7] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 2:3 • Romans 9:4-5 - *instruction going out of Zion and the word of Yahweh from Jerusalem, and the covenants and the Messiah coming through Israel*

[8] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Malachi 1:11 • Zephaniah 3:9 - *a pure offering to his name in every place among the nations, and the peoples calling on Yahweh’s name shoulder to shoulder*

[9] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18 - *a prophet like Moses raised up from among their brothers, with Yahweh’s words in his mouth*

[10] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 52:6 • Isaiah 43:10 - *my people shall know that I am he who speaks, and before me there was no God formed*

30 They went out of the city, and were coming to him.

31 In the meanwhile, the disciples urged him, saying, “Rabbi, eat.”

32 But he said to them, “I have food to eat that you don’t know about.”

33 The disciples therefore said to one another, “Has anyone brought him something to eat?”

34 Jesus said to them, “My food is to do the will of him who sent me, and to accomplish his work.

35 Don’t you say, ‘There are yet four months until the harvest?’ Behold, I tell you, lift up your eyes, and look at the fields, that they are white for harvest already.[11]

36 He who reaps receives wages, and gathers fruit to eternal life; that both he who sows and he who reaps may rejoice together.

37 For in this the saying is true, ‘One sows, and another reaps.’

38 I sent you to reap that for which you haven’t labored. Others have labored, and you have entered into their labor.”

39 From that city many of the Samaritans believed in him because of the word of the woman, who testified, “He told me everything that I did.”

40 So when the Samaritans came to him, they begged him to stay with them. He stayed there two days.

41 Many more believed because of his word.

42 They said to the woman, “Now we believe, not because of your speaking; for we have heard for ourselves, and know that this is indeed the Christ, the Savior of the world.”[12]

43 After the two days he went out from there and went into Galilee.

44 For Jesus himself testified that a prophet has no honor in his own country.[13]

45 So when he came into Galilee, the Galileans received him, having seen all the things that he did in Jerusalem at the feast, for they also went to the feast.

46 Jesus came therefore again to Cana of Galilee, where he made the water into wine. There was a certain nobleman whose son was sick at Capernaum.

47 When he heard that Jesus had come out of Judea into Galilee, he went to him, and begged him that he would come down and heal his son, for he was at the point of death.

48 Jesus therefore said to him, “Unless you see signs and wonders, you will in no way believe.”

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[11] **Cross-Reference:** Amos 9:13 • Matthew 9:37-38 - *the plowman overtaking the reaper, and the harvest plentiful but the laborers few*

[12] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 49:6 • Isaiah 45:22 - *a light to the nations so salvation reaches the end of the earth, and look to me and be saved, all the ends of the earth*

[13] **Cross-Reference:** Matthew 13:57 • Luke 4:24 - *a prophet is not without honor except in his own country*

49 The nobleman said to him, “Sir, come down before my child dies.”

50 Jesus said to him, “Go your way. Your son lives.” The man believed the word that Jesus spoke to him, and he went his way.[14]

51 As he was now going down, his servants met him and reported, saying “Your child lives!”

52 So he inquired of them the hour when he began to get better. They said therefore to him, “Yesterday at the seventh hour, the fever left him.”

53 So the father knew that it was at that hour in which Jesus said to him, “Your son lives.” He believed, as did his whole house.

54 This is again the second sign that Jesus did, having come out of Judea into Galilee.

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[14] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 107:20 • Isaiah 55:11 *- he sends his word and heals them, and the word from his mouth does not return to him empty*

CHAPTER 5 - Thirty-Eight Years by the Pool, a Mat on the Sabbath, and the Witnesses Called to the Stand

Key Notes

- The feast is not named. Readers have argued for Passover, Purim, Pentecost and Tabernacles. John names nearly every other feast he mentions, so the silence may simply mean the feast is not the point (John 5:1).
- The sheep gate was the gate the priests rebuilt and sanctified in Nehemiah's day, near the temple, where animals for sacrifice came in (John 5:2, Nehemiah 3:1).
- Five porches around a pool sounded like legend to some readers for centuries. Excavations near the church of St Anne in Jerusalem uncovered a double pool with colonnades on four sides and a fifth across the middle (John 5:2).
- The end of verse 3 and all of verse 4, the angel stirring the water, are missing from the earliest manuscripts and are printed in the WEB. Whether John wrote them or a later copyist explained the scene, verse 7 shows that this is what the sick people believed (John 5:3-4, 5:7).
- Thirty-eight years is precisely the time Israel spent between Kadesh Barnea and the brook Zered, until the whole generation that refused to go in had died. John gives the number without comment (John 5:5, Deuteronomy 2:14).
- "Do you want to be made well?" is a real question, not a cruel one. Some people have built a whole life around what is wrong with them (John 5:6).
- He never says yes. He explains why nobody helps him and someone always beats him to it. The answer to a question about wanting is a story about other people (John 5:7).
- "Arise, take up your mat, and walk" is almost word for word what Yahshua says about the paralyzed man let down through the roof in Mark. The mat was a poor man's bedroll (John 5:8, Mark 2:9).
- There is no faith required of him in the story. He does not know who healed him and cannot point Him out. Grace in this chapter goes first and asks questions later (John 5:13).
- "It was the Sabbath on that day" is withheld until after the healing, which is how John makes the reader feel the turn (John 5:9).
- Jeremiah 17 does forbid carrying a burden out of the house on the Sabbath, and Nehemiah shut the gates against the traders' loads. The man's mat was his own bed, and his accusers never once ask about what had just happened to him. Yahshua does not answer with a ruling on carrying at all. He answers with who His Father is (John 5:10, 5:17, Jeremiah 17:21-22).
- "Sin no more, so that nothing worse happens to you" links this man's past to his condition in a way Yahshua refuses to do for the man born blind four chapters later. Not all suffering comes from sin. Some does (John 5:14, 9:3).
- The healed man goes straight to the authorities with the name. Whether from fear or gratitude, the text does not say, and it is fair to notice that he never thanks anyone (John 5:15).

- “My Father is still working, so I am working too.” God rested from creating on the seventh day, but He never stopped holding the world together, giving life and receiving the dead. Yahshua claims to be doing what His Father does on the Sabbath (John 5:17, Psalm 121:4).
- They understood Him perfectly. Calling God His own Father in that sense was making Himself equal with God. Nobody in the scene thinks He is claiming to be merely a good man (John 5:18, 10:33).
- “The Son can do nothing of himself” is not weakness. It is the reverse - whatever the Father does, the Son does likewise. Total dependence and total equality in the same breath (John 5:19).
- Giving life to the dead and judging the world were the two things the Hebrew Scriptures reserve for God alone. He claims both in four verses (John 5:21-22, Deuteronomy 32:39).
- “Honor the Son, even as they honor the Father.” The same honor, not a lesser one (John 5:23).
- “Has eternal life” and “has passed out of death into life” are present and past. It is not only something waiting at the end (John 5:24).
- “Because he is a son of man” is the only place in the Gospels where the phrase has no article at all - not the Son of Man, but a son of man - which is exactly how Daniel 7 puts it (John 5:27, Daniel 7:13).
- “All who are in the tombs will hear his voice” is the clearest echo in the Gospels of Daniel 12:2 - two resurrections, one to life and one to judgment, and both come out of the grave at His voice (John 5:28-29, Daniel 12:2).
- A witness who speaks only for himself was not enough under the Torah. Every matter is established by two or three witnesses, so He calls four: John, His own works, the Father, and the Scriptures (John 5:31-39, Deuteronomy 19:15).
- John was “the burning and shining lamp” - a lamp, not the light. The same distinction the prologue made (John 5:35, 1:8).
- “You search the Scriptures” can be read as a command or a statement, and either works. The point lands the same: they read the right book and missed who it was about (John 5:39-40).
- “If another comes in his own name, you will receive him.” History is full of men who did, and were (John 5:43).
- The final witness for the prosecution is Moses. The one they claimed as theirs is the one who wrote about Him (John 5:45-47, Deuteronomy 18:15).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
The Sheep Gate	John 5:2 • Nehemiah 3:1 • Nehemiah 12:39
Thirty-Eight Years	John 5:5 • Deuteronomy 2:14 • Numbers 14:33
Burdens and the Sabbath	John 5:10 • Jeremiah 17:21-22 • Nehemiah 13:19
My Father Is Still Working	John 5:17 • Genesis 2:2-3 • Psalm 121:4

Topic	References
Equal With God	John 5:18 • John 10:33 • Philippians 2:6
Two or Three Witnesses	John 5:31 • Deuteronomy 19:15 • Deuteronomy 17:6
You Search the Scriptures	John 5:39 • Luke 24:27 • Acts 17:11
Moses Wrote About Me	John 5:46 • Deuteronomy 18:15 • Genesis 3:15

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
The Lame Man Will Leap	John 5:8 • Isaiah 35:6 • Exodus 15:26
The One Who Makes Alive	John 5:21 • Deuteronomy 32:39 • 1 Samuel 2:6
All Judgment Given to the Son	John 5:22 • Psalm 2:12 • Isaiah 11:3-4
The Dead Will Hear His Voice	John 5:25 • Ezekiel 37:4-6 • Isaiah 26:19
A Son of Man	John 5:27 • Daniel 7:13-14 • Psalm 8:4-6
Out of the Tombs	John 5:29 • Daniel 12:2 • Hosea 13:14
A Lamp for My Anointed	John 5:35 • Psalm 132:17 • Malachi 4:5

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 5 Commentary (David Guzik) - the pool of Bethesda, the Sabbath controversy, and the witnesses to the Son
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 5A - exposition of the healing at Bethesda and the Son's equality with the Father

John 5 - Opening Intro

There is a pool in Jerusalem by the sheep gate, with five porches around it, and every porch is full of sick people.

Blind. Lame. Paralyzed. All of them watching the water.

Because the story went that every so often the water would stir, and the first one in got healed. Now, your Bible may have a footnote on that part, because the earliest manuscripts leave it out. But whether John wrote it or not, that is what these people believed, and that is why they were lying there.

And one man has been lying there thirty-eight years.

Thirty-eight years. That is a whole adult life. That is the exact number of years Israel wandered between Kadesh and the brook Zered, until every man who refused to go into the land had died off. John does not point it out. He just gives you the number.

And Yahshua walks through that crowd, and He picks one man. Not the whole porch. One.

And He asks him what sounds like the strangest question in the Gospel. Do you want to be made well?

Of course he does. Right?

Listen to his answer, though. Sir, I have nobody to put me in the pool when the water is stirred. While I am coming, somebody else steps down ahead of me.

He never says yes.

He was asked if he wanted to be healed and he answered with why it was everybody else's fault.

Now, I am not mocking that man. Thirty-eight years will do that to you. You build a whole life around the thing that is wrong. You have your spot. You have your explanation. And sometimes the most frightening thing anybody can say to you is: do you want to be done with this?

And Yahshua does not wait for a better answer. Rise. Take up your mat. Walk.

And he does.

And then John drops the line he has been holding back: and it was the Sabbath on that day.

So the very first thing anybody says to a man who has not walked in thirty-eight years is: you are carrying your bed on the wrong day.

Now let us be fair about this, because I keep the Sabbath and I want to be honest with the text. Jeremiah 17 really does say not to carry a burden out of your house on the Sabbath day. They had a verse.

But look at what they did not do. Nobody asks him what happened. Nobody says, wait, you have been lying there since before some of us were born. Nobody rejoices. They walked straight past the miracle to get to the mat.

And when they come for Yahshua, look at how He answers. He does not argue about carrying. He says: My Father is still working, and I am working.

God rested from creating on the seventh day. But He never stopped holding the world together. The sun still rose on the Sabbath. Babies were still born on the Sabbath. He who keeps Israel does not slumber or sleep - not even one day a week.

And Yahshua says: that is what I am doing. What My Father does, I do.

And they understood exactly what He meant. John says that is why they wanted to kill Him - because He called God His own Father, making Himself equal with God.

Nobody in that crowd thought He was claiming to be a nice teacher.

And then He does not back down. He goes further. The Son gives life to whoever He wants. The Father has handed all judgment to the Son. Everybody should honor the Son exactly the way they honor the Father.

Giving life and judging the world. In the Hebrew Scriptures those are the two things only God does. I kill and I make alive. He claims both.

And then He says the hour is coming when everybody in the tombs will hear His voice and come out - some to the resurrection of life, some to the resurrection of judgment. That is Daniel 12 coming out of His mouth.

And then, because the Torah says a matter needs two or three witnesses, He calls His witnesses. John the Baptist. The works He is doing. The Father Himself. And the Scriptures.

And this is the line that should stop every one of us who loves the Bible. You search the Scriptures, because you think in them you have eternal life. And these are the very ones that testify about Me. And you will not come to Me.

You can know the book and miss the Person.

And His last witness is Moses. The very man they thought was on their side. If you believed Moses, you would believe Me - for he wrote about Me.

Before we read - ask yourself the question He asked that man by the pool, and try to answer it with a yes instead of a reason.

John 5:1-47 (WEB)

1 After these things, there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

2 Now in Jerusalem by the sheep gate, there is a pool, which is called in Hebrew, “Bethesda”, having five porches.[15]

3 In these lay a great multitude of those who were sick, blind, lame, or paralyzed, waiting for the moving of the water;

4 for an angel went down at certain times into the pool, and stirred up the water. Whoever stepped in first after the stirring of the water was healed of whatever disease he had.

5 A certain man was there, who had been sick for thirty-eight years.[16]

6 When Jesus saw him lying there, and knew that he had been sick for a long time, he asked him, “Do you want to be made well?”

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[15] **Cross-Reference:** Nehemiah 3:1 - *Eliashib the high priest and the priests building the sheep gate and sanctifying it*

[16] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 2:14 • Numbers 14:33 - *thirty-eight years from Kadesh Barnea to the brook Zered until a whole generation was gone, and the children wandering forty years*

7 The sick man answered him, “Sir, I have no one to put me into the pool when the water is stirred up, but while I’m coming, another steps down before me.”

8 Jesus said to him, “Arise, take up your mat, and walk.”[17]

9 Immediately, the man was made well, and took up his mat and walked. Now it was the Sabbath on that day.

10 So the Jews said to him who was cured, “It is the Sabbath. It is not lawful for you to carry the mat.”[18]

11 He answered them, “He who made me well, the same said to me, ‘Take up your mat, and walk.’”

12 Then they asked him, “Who is the man who said to you, ‘Take up your mat, and walk’?”

13 But he who was healed didn’t know who it was, for Jesus had withdrawn, a crowd being in the place.

14 Afterward Jesus found him in the temple, and said to him, “Behold, you are made well. Sin no more, so that nothing worse happens to you.”

15 The man went away, and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well.

16 For this cause the Jews persecuted Jesus, and sought to kill him, because he did these things on the Sabbath.

17 But Jesus answered them, “My Father is still working, so I am working, too.”[19]

18 For this cause therefore the Jews sought all the more to kill him, because he not only broke the Sabbath, but also called God his own Father, making himself equal with God.

19 Jesus therefore answered them, “Most certainly, I tell you, the Son can do nothing of himself, but what he sees the Father doing. For whatever things he does, these the Son also does likewise.

20 For the Father has affection for the Son, and shows him all things that he himself does. He will show him greater works than these, that you may marvel.

21 For as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, even so the Son also gives life to whom he desires.[20]

22 For the Father judges no one, but he has given all judgment to the Son,[21]

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[17] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 35:6 • Exodus 15:26 - *the lame man leaping like a deer, and I am Yahweh who heals you*

[18] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 17:21-22 • Nehemiah 13:19 - *bear no burden on the Sabbath and carry none out of your houses, and Nehemiah shutting the gates so no load came in*

[19] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 2:2-3 • Psalm 121:4 - *God resting on the seventh day and making it holy, and he who keeps Israel neither slumbering nor sleeping*

[20] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 32:39 • 1 Samuel 2:6 - *I kill and I make alive, and Yahweh who brings down to Sheol and brings up*

[21] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 2:12 • Isaiah 11:3-4 - *homage given to the Son, and the shoot of Jesse judging the poor with righteousness*

23 that all may honor the Son, even as they honor the Father. He who doesn't honor the Son doesn't honor the Father who sent him.

24 "Most certainly I tell you, he who hears my word, and believes him who sent me, has eternal life, and doesn't come into judgment, but has passed out of death into life.

25 Most certainly, I tell you, the hour comes, and now is, when the dead will hear the Son of God's voice; and those who hear will live.[22]

26 For as the Father has life in himself, even so he gave to the Son also to have life in himself.

27 He also gave him authority to execute judgment, because he is a son of man.[23]

28 Don't marvel at this, for the hour comes, in which all that are in the tombs will hear his voice,

29 and will come out; those who have done good, to the resurrection of life; and those who have done evil, to the resurrection of judgment.[24]

30 I can of myself do nothing. As I hear, I judge, and my judgment is righteous; because I don't seek my own will, but the will of my Father who sent me.

31 "If I testify about myself, my witness is not valid.[25]

32 It is another who testifies about me. I know that the testimony which he testifies about me is true.

33 You have sent to John, and he has testified to the truth.

34 But the testimony which I receive is not from man. However, I say these things that you may be saved.

35 He was the burning and shining lamp, and you were willing to rejoice for a while in his light.[26]

36 But the testimony which I have is greater than that of John, for the works which the Father gave me to accomplish, the very works that I do, testify about me, that the Father has sent me.

37 The Father himself, who sent me, has testified about me. You have neither heard his voice at any time, nor seen his form.

38 You don't have his word living in you; because you don't believe him whom he sent.

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[22] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:4-6 • Isaiah 26:19 - *dry bones told to hear the word of Yahweh and live, and your dead shall live and arise*

[23] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 7:13-14 • Psalm 8:4-6 - *one like a son of man given dominion and a kingdom, and the son of man crowned with glory and given rule*

[24] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Daniel 12:2 • Hosea 13:14 - *many who sleep in the dust awakening, some to everlasting life and some to shame, and a ransom from the power of Sheol*

[25] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 19:15 • Deuteronomy 17:6 - *every matter established at the mouth of two or three witnesses*

[26] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 132:17 • Malachi 4:5 - *a lamp ordained for my anointed, and Elijah sent before the day of Yahweh*

39 “You search the Scriptures, because you think that in them you have eternal life; and these are they which testify about me.[27]

40 Yet you will not come to me, that you may have life.

41 I don’t receive glory from men.

42 But I know you, that you don’t have God’s love in yourselves.

43 I have come in my Father’s name, and you don’t receive me. If another comes in his own name, you will receive him.

44 How can you believe, who receive glory from one another, and you don’t seek the glory that comes from the only God?

45 “Don’t think that I will accuse you to the Father. There is one who accuses you, even Moses, on whom you have set your hope.

46 For if you believed Moses, you would believe me; for he wrote about me.[28]

47 But if you don’t believe his writings, how will you believe my words?”

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[27] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 24:27 • Acts 17:11 - *beginning from Moses and all the prophets he explained the things concerning himself, and the Bereans examining the Scriptures daily*

[28] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 18:15 • Genesis 3:15 - *a prophet like Moses to whom you shall listen, and the seed of the woman who bruises the serpent’s head*

CHAPTER 6 - Five Barley Loaves, I AM on the Water, and the Bread That Came Down From Heaven

Key Notes

- John alone calls the lake the Sea of Tiberias, after the city Herod Antipas built on its shore and named for the emperor. His readers knew it by that name (John 6:1, 21:1).
- “The Passover, the feast of the Jews, was at hand.” This is the second Passover John marks, and everything in the chapter happens in its shadow: bread, a crossing of water, and manna in the wilderness (John 6:4, 2:13, 11:55).
- He asks Philip where to buy bread, and John adds that He already knew what He would do. Philip was from Bethsaida, the nearest town. It was a test, and Philip answers it with arithmetic (John 6:5-7, 1:44).
- Two hundred denarii was about two hundred days’ wages for a laborer, most of a year’s pay, and Philip says it would not be enough for everyone to get a little (John 6:7, Matthew 20:2).
- Moses asked almost the same question in the wilderness. Where could I get meat to give all these people? Would all the fish of the sea be enough? (John 6:5, Numbers 11:13, 11:22).
- Only John says the loaves were barley, the cheap bread of the poor, and only John mentions the boy who had them. Elisha once fed a hundred men with twenty barley loaves and had some left over (John 6:9, 2 Kings 4:42-44).
- “There was much grass in the place” - spring, as Passover would be. Mark says green grass. Small details like this are how eyewitness memory reads (John 6:10, Mark 6:39).
- “Gather up the broken pieces which are left over, that nothing be lost.” The same word, lost, is used about two dozen verses later for the people the Father gives Him: of all He has given Me, I should lose nothing (John 6:12, 6:39).
- Twelve baskets left - one for each of the twelve who had just watched the arithmetic fail (John 6:13).
- “This is truly the prophet who comes into the world” is the prophet like Moses of Deuteronomy 18. They had just watched bread appear in the wilderness, which is exactly what you would expect a new Moses to do (John 6:14, Deuteronomy 18:15).
- They wanted to take Him by force and make Him king. He withdrew to the mountain alone. A crown offered by a full stomach is not the kingdom (John 6:15).
- Twenty-five or thirty stadia is three or four miles - the middle of the lake, at night, rowing into the wind (John 6:19).
- In the Hebrew Scriptures the one who walks on the waves of the sea is God. Job says He alone treads on them. The psalm says His way was through the sea and His footsteps were not seen (John 6:19, Job 9:8, Psalm 77:19).

- “It is I” is ego eimi again, the same two words He spoke to the woman at the well. On the water in the dark they carry their full weight: I AM. Don’t be afraid (John 6:20, 4:26).
- “Immediately the boat was at the land where they were going.” John gives no explanation and does not need one (John 6:21, Psalm 107:30).
- “You seek me, not because you saw signs, but because you ate of the loaves.” They had the bread and missed the sign. The bread was the point to them; it was the pointer to Him (John 6:26).
- “Him the Father, God, has sealed” uses the image of a seal pressed into wax, the mark that proves who owns or sent something (John 6:27).
- What must we do to do the works of God? The answer is one work, singular: believe in the one He sent (John 6:28-29).
- They ask for a sign after watching five thousand eat. Then they quote the manna. Moses gave our fathers bread from heaven. They are asking Him to top it (John 6:30-31, Psalm 78:24).
- He corrects three things in one sentence: it was not Moses, it was My Father; not gave, but gives; and the true bread is not something but someone (John 6:32-33).
- “I am the bread of life” is the first of seven I AM sayings with a picture attached: bread, light, door, good shepherd, resurrection, way, vine (John 6:35, 8:12, 10:9, 10:11, 11:25, 14:6, 15:1).
- “Him who comes to me I will in no way throw out.” The Greek doubles the negative. Never, under any circumstances (John 6:37).
- “I will raise him up at the last day” is said four times in this chapter. Whatever else this bread means, it ends in resurrection (John 6:39, 40, 44, 54).
- The Jews murmured, which is the wilderness word. Israel murmured against Moses over the bread, and Moses told them their murmuring was against Yahweh (John 6:41, Exodus 16:8).
- “They will all be taught by God” is Isaiah 54. The drawing of the Father is not a feeling but a teaching, and those who learn come (John 6:44-45, Isaiah 54:13).
- From verse 54 on, the verb for eat changes to one that means to chew or gnaw. He does not soften the image when they object. He makes it harder (John 6:54-58).
- Drinking blood was forbidden from Noah onward, because the life is in the blood. To a Jewish ear this is the most offensive thing He could say - unless He is saying that His life is the life given for theirs (John 6:53, Leviticus 17:11).
- “The Spirit gives life; the flesh profits nothing. The words that I speak to you are spirit, and are life.” The way into the hard saying is through the words, not around them (John 6:63).
- Many of His disciples turned back and walked with Him no more. They did not stop believing in God. They stopped walking with Him (John 6:66).
- “You have the words of eternal life” is the answer to the words that drove everyone else away. Peter does not say he understands. He says there is nowhere else to go (John 6:68).

- "The Holy One of God" is the title a demon shouted in the synagogue at Capernaum. Here a disciple says it on purpose (John 6:69, Mark 1:24).
- He chose twelve and one of them is a devil. Judas was chosen too, and stayed through all of it (John 6:70-71).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Where Shall We Buy Bread?	John 6:5 • Numbers 11:13 • Numbers 11:22
Barley Loaves for a Crowd	John 6:9 • 2 Kings 4:42-44
Satisfied, With Some Left Over	John 6:12 • Ruth 2:14 • Exodus 16:19-20
Bread From Heaven	John 6:31 • Exodus 16:4 • Psalm 78:24-25
Murmuring in the Wilderness	John 6:41 • Exodus 16:8 • Numbers 11:1
All Taught by God	John 6:45 • Isaiah 54:13 • Jeremiah 31:34
The Life Is in the Blood	John 6:53 • Leviticus 17:11 • Genesis 9:4
To Whom Would We Go?	John 6:68 • Psalm 73:25 • Deuteronomy 32:47

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
The Prophet Who Comes Into the World	John 6:14 • Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18
He Treads on the Waves of the Sea	John 6:19 • Job 9:8 • Psalm 77:19
I Am, Do Not Be Afraid	John 6:20 • Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 43:2
The Bread of Life	John 6:35 • Isaiah 55:1-2 • Deuteronomy 8:3
Raised Up at the Last Day	John 6:40 • Isaiah 26:19 • Job 19:25-26
Flesh Given for the Life of the World	John 6:51 • Isaiah 53:5 • Isaiah 53:12
The Holy One of God	John 6:69 • Psalm 16:10 • Isaiah 49:7

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 6 Commentary (David Guzik) - the feeding of the five thousand, the walk on the water, and the bread of life discourse
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three

- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 6A - exposition of the feeding of the five thousand and the manna background

John 6 - Opening Intro

This chapter happens with Passover in the air. And once you notice that, you cannot stop seeing it.

There is bread in the wilderness. There is a crossing of water. There is murmuring. And there is manna. It is the Exodus all over again, and Yahshua is standing in the middle of it.

A huge crowd follows Him around the lake because they have seen Him heal. And He looks up and says to Philip: where are we going to buy bread for all these people?

John tells us He was testing him. He already knew what He was going to do.

And Philip does what most of us do with a test. He does the math. Two hundred denarii would not buy enough for everybody to get a bite.

Two hundred denarii is most of a year's wages. Philip is basically saying: we could work all year and it would still not be enough.

And you know who else asked that exact question? Moses. In the wilderness, with the people crying for meat. Where am I supposed to get meat for all these people? If we caught every fish in the sea would it be enough?

Then Andrew says: there is a boy here with five barley loaves and two fish. And then he answers himself - but what is that among so many?

Barley. John is the only one who tells us that. Barley was the bread of poor people. This is not a feast. This is a kid's lunch.

And Yahshua says: have the people sit down. And John notices there was a lot of grass - because it is spring, Passover season - and five thousand men sit down on it.

He gives thanks. He hands it out. And they eat as much as they want.

And then He says: gather up what is left over, so that nothing is lost.

Hold onto that word, lost. Because about twenty-five verses later He is going to say: this is the will of My Father, that of everyone He has given Me, I should lose nothing.

The way He handles bread is the way He handles people. Nothing gets thrown away.

Twelve baskets of leftovers. One for every disciple who had just watched the math fail.

And the crowd sees it and says: this is the Prophet. The one like Moses. And they are right. And then they try to grab Him and make Him king.

And He leaves. He goes up the mountain by Himself.

He will not take a crown from people whose stomachs are full.

Then night falls, and the disciples are in the boat without Him, rowing into a storm, three or four miles out. And they see Him walking on the sea.

Now, every Jew in that boat knew who walks on the sea. Job says God alone treads on the waves. The psalm says His path went through the great waters and nobody saw His footprints.

And they are terrified. And He says two words: ego eimi. It is I. And if you know your Exodus, it is also: I AM. Do not be afraid.

And the moment they take Him into the boat, they are at the shore.

Next day the crowd finds Him on the other side, and He tells them the truth. You are not looking for Me because you saw a sign. You are looking for Me because you ate bread and got full.

They wanted the bread. The bread was supposed to point at Him.

And then they ask for a sign. The day after five thousand people ate out of five loaves. And they bring up Moses - our fathers ate manna in the wilderness. Can You top that?

And He says: it was not Moses who gave you bread from heaven. My Father gives you the true bread from heaven.

And then: I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to Me will never hunger. Whoever believes in Me will never thirst.

And they start murmuring. Same word as the wilderness. Same people, same complaint, same bread.

And instead of making it easier, He makes it harder. Unless you eat My flesh and drink My blood, you have no life in you.

Now hear how that sounded. Blood was the one thing God said, from Noah onward, you do not eat - because the life is in the blood. And He says: drink Mine.

Unless the point is exactly that. The life is in the blood. And He is offering His.

And when they object, He changes the word for eat to one that means to chew. He does not back off one inch.

And the crowd leaves. Even many of His disciples. They turn back and stop walking with Him.

And He turns to the twelve and asks the question every one of us gets asked eventually. Will you also go away?

And Peter says the best thing anybody says in this whole chapter. He does not say he understands. He says: Lord, to whom would we go? You have the words of eternal life.

Before we read - notice that the crowd wanted bread, the leaders wanted a sign, and Peter just wanted Him. Only one of those stayed.

John 6:1-71 (WEB)

1 After these things, Jesus went away to the other side of the sea of Galilee, which is also called the Sea of Tiberias.

2 A great multitude followed him, because they saw his signs which he did on those who were sick.

3 Jesus went up into the mountain, and he sat there with his disciples.

4 Now the Passover, the feast of the Jews, was at hand.

5 Jesus therefore lifting up his eyes, and seeing that a great multitude was coming to him, said to Philip, "Where are we to buy bread, that these may eat?"[29]

6 This he said to test him, for he himself knew what he would do.

7 Philip answered him, "Two hundred denarii worth of bread is not sufficient for them, that everyone of them may receive a little."

8 One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, said to him,

9 "There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish, but what are these among so many?"[30]

10 Jesus said, "Have the people sit down." Now there was much grass in that place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.

11 Jesus took the loaves; and having given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to those who were sitting down; likewise also of the fish as much as they desired.

12 When they were filled, he said to his disciples, "Gather up the broken pieces which are left over, that nothing be lost."[31]

13 So they gathered them up, and filled twelve baskets with broken pieces from the five barley loaves, which were left over by those who had eaten.

14 When therefore the people saw the sign which Jesus did, they said, "This is truly the prophet who comes into the world."[32]

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[29] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 11:13 • Numbers 11:22 - *Moses asking where he could get meat for all the people, and whether all the fish of the sea would be enough*

[30] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Kings 4:42-44 - *twenty barley loaves set before a hundred men, and they ate and left some over, according to Yahweh's word*

[31] **Cross-Reference:** Ruth 2:14 • Exodus 16:19-20 - *Ruth eating until she was satisfied and having some left, and the manna kept overnight that bred worms*

[32] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:15 • Deuteronomy 18:18 - *a prophet like Moses raised up from among their brothers, with Yahweh's words in his mouth*

15 Jesus therefore, perceiving that they were about to come and take him by force, to make him king, withdrew again to the mountain by himself.

16 When evening came, his disciples went down to the sea,

17 and they entered into the boat, and were going over the sea to Capernaum. It was now dark, and Jesus had not come to them.

18 The sea was tossed by a great wind blowing.

19 When therefore they had rowed about twenty-five or thirty stadia, they saw Jesus walking on the sea, and drawing near to the boat; and they were afraid.[33]

20 But he said to them, "It is I. Don't be afraid."[34]

21 They were willing therefore to receive him into the boat. Immediately the boat was at the land where they were going.

22 On the next day, the multitude that stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was no other boat there, except the one in which his disciples had embarked, and that Jesus hadn't entered with his disciples into the boat, but his disciples had gone away alone.

23 However boats from Tiberias came near to the place where they ate the bread after the Lord had given thanks.

24 When the multitude therefore saw that Jesus wasn't there, nor his disciples, they themselves got into the boats, and came to Capernaum, seeking Jesus.

25 When they found him on the other side of the sea, they asked him, "Rabbi, when did you come here?"

26 Jesus answered them, "Most certainly I tell you, you seek me, not because you saw signs, but because you ate of the loaves, and were filled.

27 Don't work for the food which perishes, but for the food which remains to eternal life, which the Son of Man will give to you. For God the Father has sealed him."

28 They said therefore to him, "What must we do, that we may work the works of God?"

29 Jesus answered them, "This is the work of God, that you believe in him whom he has sent."

30 They said therefore to him, "What then do you do for a sign, that we may see, and believe you? What work do you do?

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[33] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Job 9:8 • Psalm 77:19 - *he alone treads on the waves of the sea, and your way was through the sea with footsteps not known*

[34] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 3:14 • Isaiah 43:2 - *I AM WHO I AM, and when you pass through the waters I will be with you*

31 Our fathers ate the manna in the wilderness. As it is written, ‘He gave them bread out of heaven to eat.’”[35]

32 Jesus therefore said to them, “Most certainly, I tell you, it wasn’t Moses who gave you the bread out of heaven, but my Father gives you the true bread out of heaven.

33 For the bread of God is that which comes down out of heaven, and gives life to the world.”

34 They said therefore to him, “Lord, always give us this bread.”

35 Jesus said to them, “I am the bread of life. He who comes to me will not be hungry, and he who believes in me will never be thirsty.[36]

36 But I told you that you have seen me, and yet you don’t believe.

37 All those whom the Father gives me will come to me. He who comes to me I will in no way throw out.

38 For I have come down from heaven, not to do my own will, but the will of him who sent me.

39 This is the will of my Father who sent me, that of all he has given to me I should lose nothing, but should raise him up at the last day.

40 This is the will of the one who sent me, that everyone who sees the Son, and believes in him, should have eternal life; and I will raise him up at the last day.”[37]

41 The Jews therefore murmured concerning him, because he said, “I am the bread which came down out of heaven.”[38]

42 They said, “Isn’t this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How then does he say, ‘I have come down out of heaven?’”

43 Therefore Jesus answered them, “Don’t murmur among yourselves.

44 No one can come to me unless the Father who sent me draws him, and I will raise him up in the last day.

45 It is written in the prophets, ‘They will all be taught by God.’ Therefore everyone who hears from the Father, and has learned, comes to me.[39]

46 Not that anyone has seen the Father, except he who is from God. He has seen the Father.

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[35] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 16:4 • Psalm 78:24-25 - *bread rained from heaven for the people, and the grain of heaven, the bread of angels*

[36] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 55:1-2 • Deuteronomy 8:3 - *come, buy and eat without money, and man does not live by bread only but by every word from Yahweh’s mouth*

[37] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 26:19 • Job 19:25-26 - *your dead shall live and arise, and my Redeemer standing on the earth at the last, seen in my flesh*

[38] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 16:8 • Numbers 11:1 - *your murmurings are not against us but against Yahweh, and the people complaining in the ears of Yahweh*

[39] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 54:13 • Jeremiah 31:34 - *all your children taught by Yahweh, and they shall all know me, from the least to the greatest*

47 Most certainly, I tell you, he who believes in me has eternal life.

48 I am the bread of life.

49 Your fathers ate the manna in the wilderness, and they died.

50 This is the bread which comes down out of heaven, that anyone may eat of it and not die.

51 I am the living bread which came down out of heaven. If anyone eats of this bread, he will live forever. Yes, the bread which I will give for the life of the world is my flesh."[40]

52 The Jews therefore contended with one another, saying, "How can this man give us his flesh to eat?"

53 Jesus therefore said to them, "Most certainly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you don't have life in yourselves.[41]

54 He who eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise him up at the last day.

55 For my flesh is food indeed, and my blood is drink indeed.

56 He who eats my flesh and drinks my blood lives in me, and I in him.

57 As the living Father sent me, and I live because of the Father; so he who feeds on me, he will also live because of me.

58 This is the bread which came down out of heaven—not as our fathers ate the manna, and died. He who eats this bread will live forever."

59 He said these things in the synagogue, as he taught in Capernaum.

60 Therefore many of his disciples, when they heard this, said, "This is a hard saying! Who can listen to it?"

61 But Jesus knowing in himself that his disciples murmured at this, said to them, "Does this cause you to stumble?

62 Then what if you would see the Son of Man ascending to where he was before?

63 It is the spirit who gives life. The flesh profits nothing. The words that I speak to you are spirit, and are life.

64 But there are some of you who don't believe." For Jesus knew from the beginning who they were who didn't believe, and who it was who would betray him.

65 He said, "For this cause I have said to you that no one can come to me, unless it is given to him by my Father."

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[40] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:5 • Isaiah 53:12 - *pierced for our transgressions and healed by his wounds, and pouring out his soul to death to bear the sin of many*

[41] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 17:11 • Genesis 9:4 - *the life of the flesh is in the blood, given on the altar to make atonement, and flesh with its blood you shall not eat*

66 At this, many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.

67 Jesus said therefore to the twelve, “You don’t also want to go away, do you?”

68 Simon Peter answered him, “Lord, to whom would we go? You have the words of eternal life.[42]

69 We have come to believe and know that you are the Christ, the Son of the living God.”[43]

70 Jesus answered them, “Didn’t I choose you, the twelve, and one of you is a devil?”

71 Now he spoke of Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot, for it was he who would betray him, being one of the twelve.

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[42] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 73:25 • Deuteronomy 32:47 - *whom do I have in heaven but you, and the word that is no vain thing because it is your life*

[43] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 16:10 • Isaiah 49:7 - *you will not let your holy one see corruption, and the Holy One of Israel who has chosen you*

Major Themes Across John 4-6

- The Word made flesh, tired enough to sit down on the edge of a well
- A road through Samaria that He needed to take, and a woman He went to find
- Three walls crossed with one request for a drink
- Living water mistaken for plumbing, and offered anyway
- A past named without shame and without being skipped
- Worship that is no longer a question of which mountain
- A Father who goes looking for worshippers
- I am He, said first to a Samaritan woman at noon
- A water jar left behind by someone who found a well
- A whole town brought by the person who had been avoiding it
- Food the disciples did not know about: doing the will of the one who sent Him
- Fields already white, and Samaritans coming down the road
- The Savior of the world, named first by outsiders
- A father who believed a sentence before he saw anything
- A word that healed from twenty miles away at the very hour it was spoken
- Thirty-eight years by a pool, the length of a wilderness generation
- Do you want to be made well, answered with a reason instead of a yes
- Grace that went first and asked questions later
- Accusers who walked past a miracle to get to a mat
- A Father who never stops working, and a Son who does what He does
- Equality with God, understood perfectly by those who rejected it
- Life and judgment, the two works only God does, claimed by the Son
- All who are in the tombs hearing His voice
- Four witnesses called, because the Torah requires more than one
- Searching the Scriptures and missing the Person they are about
- Moses, called as the final witness against those who claimed him
- A boy’s barley lunch in the hands of the one who made the grain
- Fragments gathered so that nothing is lost, as He loses none of His
- A crown refused because it was offered by full stomachs
- The one who treads on the waves of the sea, saying I AM in the dark
- Bread wanted, sign missed, and the Giver overlooked
- Not Moses but My Father, not gave but gives, not something but someone

- A hard saying made harder rather than softer
- The life in the blood, offered for the life of the world
- Will you also go away, and nowhere else to go

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May we take the road He needs us to take, even through Samaria.

May we ask for living water and stop settling for still water.

May we let Him name what we came out at noon to avoid.

May we stop changing the subject when He gets close.

May we be the worshippers the Father is looking for.

May we worship in spirit and in truth, and never trade one for the other.

May we leave our water jars where they fall.

May the people who know our past hear us say come and see.

May our food be to do the will of the One who sent us.

May we lift up our eyes and see the fields already white.

May we believe the word before we see the sign.

May we go our way on nothing but a sentence from Him.

May we answer do you want to be made well with a yes, and not a reason.

May we rise, and take up what held us, and walk.

May we never walk past a miracle to argue about a mat.

May we honor the Son as we honor the Father.

May we hear His voice now, and come out when He calls.

May we search the Scriptures and find the Person in them.

May we believe Moses, and so believe the One he wrote about.

May we hand Him what little we have and watch it feed thousands.

May nothing He gives us be wasted, and no one He gives us be lost.

May we refuse every crown offered by a full stomach.

May we hear I AM in the storm and stop being afraid.

May we come for Him and not only for the bread.

May we feed on Him who is the bread of life.

May we never be thrown out by the One who promised He would not.

May we stay when the hard sayings come.

May we say with Peter: to whom would we go? You have the words of eternal life.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.